. The phrases quoted in this sentence are from H.M. Elliot's translation of extracts from Badauni's work published in *The History of India, As Told by Its Own Historians*, vol. 5 (Trübner and Co., 1873).
. R.C. Majumdar, 'Preface', in *The Mughul Empire*, ed. R.C. Majumdar (Bharatiya Vidya Bhavan, 1974).
. 'The Happy Sayings of His Majesty', in Abu'l Fazl, *The Ain-i-Akbari*, vol. 3, trans. Col. H.S. Jarrett (First published 1927; Low Price Publications, 2014).
. Guru Arjan Dev completed the Adi Granth in 1604. This was the first edition of what would become the Guru Granth Sahib, the holy book of the Sikh religion.
. B.B. Majumdar, 'Hindu Religion', in *The Mughul Empire*, ed. R.C. Majumdar (Bharatiya Vidya Bhavan, 1974).
. Editors' introduction to Fr. Antonio Monserrate, *The Commentary of Father Monserrate, S.J. on his Journey to the Court of Akbar*, trans. J.S. Hoyland, annotations S.N. Banerjee (Oxford University Press, 1922).
. Banarasidas, *Ardhakathanak* (A Half Story), trans. Rohini Chowdhury (Penguin Books, 2009).
. The free movement of people across Hindustan is another aspect of life at this time that Banarasi's autobiography reveals. The poet's father, for example, was born in Narwar, raised in Jaunpur, got his first job in Bengal, his second in Agra, and was married in Meerut – all by the age of eighteen or so. Banarasi travelled fairly extensively, too. As a young man, he went from Jaunpur to Agra, hoping to start his own jewellery business. The poet had little talent for trade, however. He lost most of the jewels he'd taken with him, 'Tied into his underpants': the pearls tucked along with the drawstring of his pyjama rolled away, mice ran off with his rubies. Banarasi was soon bankrupt, sitting at home reading his poems to a small group of men, one of whom was a kachauriwalla who gave Banarasi a seer of kachauris on credit. 'He told no one of his situation / But lived on the kachauris he bought on credit.' See Banarasidas, *Ardhakathanak*.
. The story of the brahmin and the qazi is told in H.M. Elliot's translation of Badauni in *The History of India, As Told by Its Own Historians*, vol. 5.
. The description of Abdun Nabi's arrogance and power is from Badauni, *Muntakhab-ut-Tawarikh*, trans. W.H. Lowe.
. Badauni tells of another grudge that Akbar held against his sadr. Once, there was a discussion on how many wives Akbar might have by law and the emperor quoted Abdun Nabi as having said nine. When asked to confirm, however, the shaikh equivocated, saying he only meant that the question was debated. 'This annoyed His Majesty very much. "The Shaikh," said he, "told me at that time a very different thing to what he tells me now." He never forgot this.' Badauni, *Muntakhab-ut-Tawarikh*, trans. W.H. Lowe.
. Equally wittily, Badauni once wrote of how 'jealousy, hypocrisy, and envy' were 'to the saints of Hindustan, in their feelings towards one another . . . the very necessaries of life'. Ibid.
. Shaikh Tajuddin would invent the flattering custom of '*zamin-bos*', kissing the floor when greeting the emperor, an obeisance very similar to the *sijda* that became de rigueur in Akbar's court.
. Badauni, *Muntakhab-ut-Tawarikh*, trans. W.H. Lowe.
. Ibid., Translator's note.
. Badauni, *Muntakhab-ut-Tawarikh*, trans. W.H. Lowe.
. Abul Fazl's thoughts on the distressed debaters in the Ibadat Khana are from Abu'l Fazl, *The History of Akbar*, vol. 6, trans. W.M. Thackston.
. Ibid.
. *The Akbarnama of Abu'l Fazl*, vol. 3. The description of the battle that follows is based on Abul Fazl's account.
. Harbans Mukhia, *The Mughals of India* (Blackwell Publishing, 2004; Indian reprint by Wiley India,